Observation - Week 03

Topic: Node.js and Express.js

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Aim

To build a REST API server for expenses using Node.js and Express with routing and middleware.

Concepts Covered

- Node runtime, modules (require / module.exports), npm
- Express app, routers and middleware
- HTTP methods and status codes
- Testing endpoints with Postman

Observations

- express.json() middleware is required for req.body to be populated.
- Middleware runs in the order it is registered, so logging must come first.
- Returning proper status codes (201, 400, 404) makes the API self-explanatory.
- Express Router keeps route files separate from server setup.

Viva Questions

1 What is middleware?

2 What is the event loop in Node.js?

3 Difference between PUT and PATCH?

4 What does next() do?

Reference Files

- src/server.js
- src/routes/api.js
- src/package.json
- screenshots/express-server-terminal.png
- screenshots/postman-api-response.png